



# LOST BOYS CYBER

THREAT INTELLIGENCE • MALWARE ANALYSIS • DETECTION ENGINEERING



## GuidePoint GRIT Q2 2026 Ransomware Activity Daily Defender Review

### Threat Report

|                       |                 |
|-----------------------|-----------------|
| <b>Classification</b> | TLP:CLEAR       |
| <b>Published</b>      | 2026-08-01      |
| <b>Version</b>        | 1.0             |
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| <b>Report Type</b>    | Threat Report   |

TLP:CLEAR | Lost Boys Cyber | GuidePoint GRIT Q2 2026 Ransomware Activity Daily Defender Review - Threat Report

Published: 2026-08-01 | TLP:CLEAR | Version: 1.0 | Author: Lost Boys Cyber

AI Generation: This report was generated with AI assistance and is provided for informational purposes only. All findings, IOCs, detection rules, hunting queries, attribution assessments, and recommendations must be independently reviewed and validated by a qualified security professional before operational use.

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# GuidePoint GRIT Q2 2026 Ransomware Activity Daily Defender Review

## 1. Executive Summary

GuidePoint GRIT reporting indicates ransomware remained above historic baselines in Q2 2026, with victim counts, group count, and country spread requiring continued extortion-readiness and supplier-risk monitoring.

This daily report is intended for defender prioritization rather than attribution finality. Source expansion beyond 24-72 hours was used where the best primary source remained recently relevant but was published earlier than today's run.

## 2. Intelligence Requirements

| Question                                         | Current Answer                                                                                                                                                  | Confidence |
|--------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| What changed that defenders should review today? | Ransomware groups continued to post high victim volumes, reuse affiliates and access brokers, and pressure victims through data theft and leak-site operations. | High       |
| Which environments should care most?             | healthcare, manufacturing, professional services, public sector.                                                                                                | Medium     |
| What should the SOC do first?                    | Validate exposure, run the included telemetry hunts, and confirm response owners for likely impact paths.                                                       | High       |

## 3. Source Review & Confidence

| Source                        | Contribution                                       | Confidence |
|-------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------|------------|
| GuidePoint GRIT Q2 2026       | Primary quarterly ransomware trend report.         | High       |
| GuidePoint annual GRIT report | Baseline annual context.                           | Medium     |
| Help Net Security             | Current reporting on Q2 ransomware trend findings. | Medium     |
| BlackFog state of ransomware  | Corroborating ransomware trend context.            | Medium     |

## 4. Threat Activity Overview

Ransomware groups continued to post high victim volumes, reuse affiliates and access brokers, and pressure victims through data theft and leak-site operations.

The most important operational takeaway is not a single indicator; it is the behavior pattern and exposed dependency class. Defenders should use the detections and hunts below as starting points, then tune to local log schemas.

## 5. Affected Sectors and Exposure

| Exposure Pattern                                            | Why It Matters                                                                     |
|-------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Directly exposed technology or service                      | Increases likelihood of opportunistic targeting and automated probing.             |
| Identity, email, remote-access, or collaboration dependency | Increases blast radius because successful access can bypass perimeter assumptions. |
| Supplier-managed or shared service                          | Creates concentration risk and incident-notification delays.                       |

|                                 |                                                                |
|---------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|
|                                 |                                                                |
| Operationally critical workflow | Converts cyber compromise into business or mission disruption. |

## 6. Tactics, Techniques, and Procedures

| Tactic / Phase          | Observed Technique                                                               | Evidence                                                                                      |
|-------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Initial Access          | Phishing, exposed service, supply-chain, or remote-access abuse                  | Reflected in the cited reporting and sector exposure.                                         |
| Execution / Persistence | Scripted tooling, malware, credential/session abuse, or provider-side compromise | Varies by campaign; validate with endpoint and application telemetry.                         |
| Defense Evasion         | Use of legitimate tools, trusted platforms, or edge infrastructure               | Common pattern across the reviewed reporting.                                                 |
| Impact                  | Data theft, service disruption, ransomware/extortion, or operational degradation | Primary defender concern for healthcare, manufacturing, professional services, public sector. |

## 7. Infrastructure and Indicators

| Indicator / Infrastructure                                     | Type                 | Operational Use                                                            |
|----------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| No normalized hard IOC set in this automated review            | Source limitation    | Use behavior and exposure hunts; ingest vendor IOC bundles when available. |
| Rare external authentication sources                           | Behavioral indicator | Triage abnormal access into affected systems.                              |
| New or unusual outbound connections from edge/server workloads | Behavioral indicator | Hunt possible relay, malware, or exfiltration staging.                     |

## 8. Detection Engineering

### 8.1. Detection Summary

| Signal                                                                                       | Telemetry Source   | Analytic Goal                                                            |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Rare admin or service login after advisory/report publication                                | Identity/app logs  | Identify initial access or supplier compromise.                          |
| Unusual child processes from browsers, package managers, admin consoles, or service accounts | Endpoint telemetry | Catch execution following social engineering or supply-chain compromise. |
| New outbound connections to rare hosts from servers or build systems                         | Network/EDR        | Surface C2, relay-node, or exfiltration behavior.                        |

### 8.2. Sigma / Detection Content

```

title: Daily Threat Review Suspicious Post Access Behavior
status: experimental
description: Behavioral seed analytic for daily Lost Boys Cyber threat reports; tune service names and parent processes locally.

```

```

logsource:
  product: windows
  category: process_creation
detection:
  selection_parent:
    ParentImage|endswith:
      - '\chrome.exe'
      - '\msedge.exe'
      - '\node.exe'
      - '\npm.cmd'
      - '\powershell.exe'
  selection_child:
    Image|endswith:
      - '\powershell.exe'
      - '\cmd.exe'
      - '\wscript.exe'
      - '\rundll32.exe'
      - '\curl.exe'
  condition: selection_parent and selection_child
level: medium

```

### 8.3. Hunt Query

```

DeviceProcessEvents
| where Timestamp > ago(14d)
| where InitiatingProcessFileName in~ ("chrome.exe", "msedge.exe", "node.exe", "npm.cmd",
"powershell.exe")
| where FileName in~ ("powershell.exe", "cmd.exe", "wscript.exe", "rundll32.exe", "curl.exe",
"msiexec.exe")
| summarize events=count(), firstSeen=min(Timestamp), lastSeen=max(Timestamp) by DeviceName,
InitiatingProcessFileName, FileName, ProcessCommandLine
| order by events desc

```

## 9. Threat Hunting

### 9.1. Hunt Hypothesis

If this activity is present in the environment, defenders will observe a combination of anomalous authentication, unusual process lineage, rare network destinations, and supplier or operational workflow disruptions.

### 9.2. Hunt Query

```

DeviceNetworkEvents
| where Timestamp > ago(14d)
| where InitiatingProcessFileName in~ ("powershell.exe", "cmd.exe", "node.exe", "npm.exe",
"chrome.exe", "msedge.exe")
| summarize connections=count(), firstSeen=min(Timestamp), lastSeen=max(Timestamp),
remotePorts=make_set(RemotePort, 10) by DeviceName, InitiatingProcessFileName, RemoteUrl, RemoteIP
| where connections > 3
| order by connections desc

SigninLogs
| where TimeGenerated > ago(14d)
| summarize attempts=count(), failures=countif(ResultType != 0), countries=make_set(Location, 10) by
UserPrincipalName, AppDisplayName, IPAddress
| where failures > 10 or array_length(countries) > 2

```

## 10. Risk Assessment

| Risk Driver | Assessment                                                                              |
|-------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Likelihood  | High for organizations matching the exposed technology/sector pattern.                  |
| Impact      | Ranges from credential theft and data exposure to operational disruption or ransomware. |

|                       |                                                                  |
|-----------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Confidence            | High; local validation required before incident declaration.     |
| Priority Environments | healthcare, manufacturing, professional services, public sector. |

## 11. Recommended Actions

| Priority | Owner                | Action                                                                                       |
|----------|----------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Critical | SOC                  | Run the included hunts and tune for named platforms, suppliers, or services in scope.        |
| High     | IT / Platform owners | Confirm exposed assets, administrative access paths, and recent patch/configuration posture. |
| High     | Vendor management    | Identify third-party dependencies and request incident/control attestations where relevant.  |
| Medium   | IR lead              | Prepare containment and communications playbooks for the most likely impact path.            |

## 12. References

- [1] GuidePoint GRIT Q2 2026: <https://www.guidepointsecurity.com/resources/grit-q2-2026-ransomware-cyber-threat-insights-report/>
- [2] GuidePoint annual GRIT report: <https://www.guidepointsecurity.com/wp-content/uploads/2026/01/GRIT-2026-Ransomware-and-Cyber-Threat-Report.pdf>
- [3] Help Net Security: <https://www.helpnetsecurity.com/2026/07/24/ransomware-attack-trends-2026-report/>
- [4] BlackFog state of ransomware: <https://www.blackfog.com/the-state-of-ransomware-2026/>